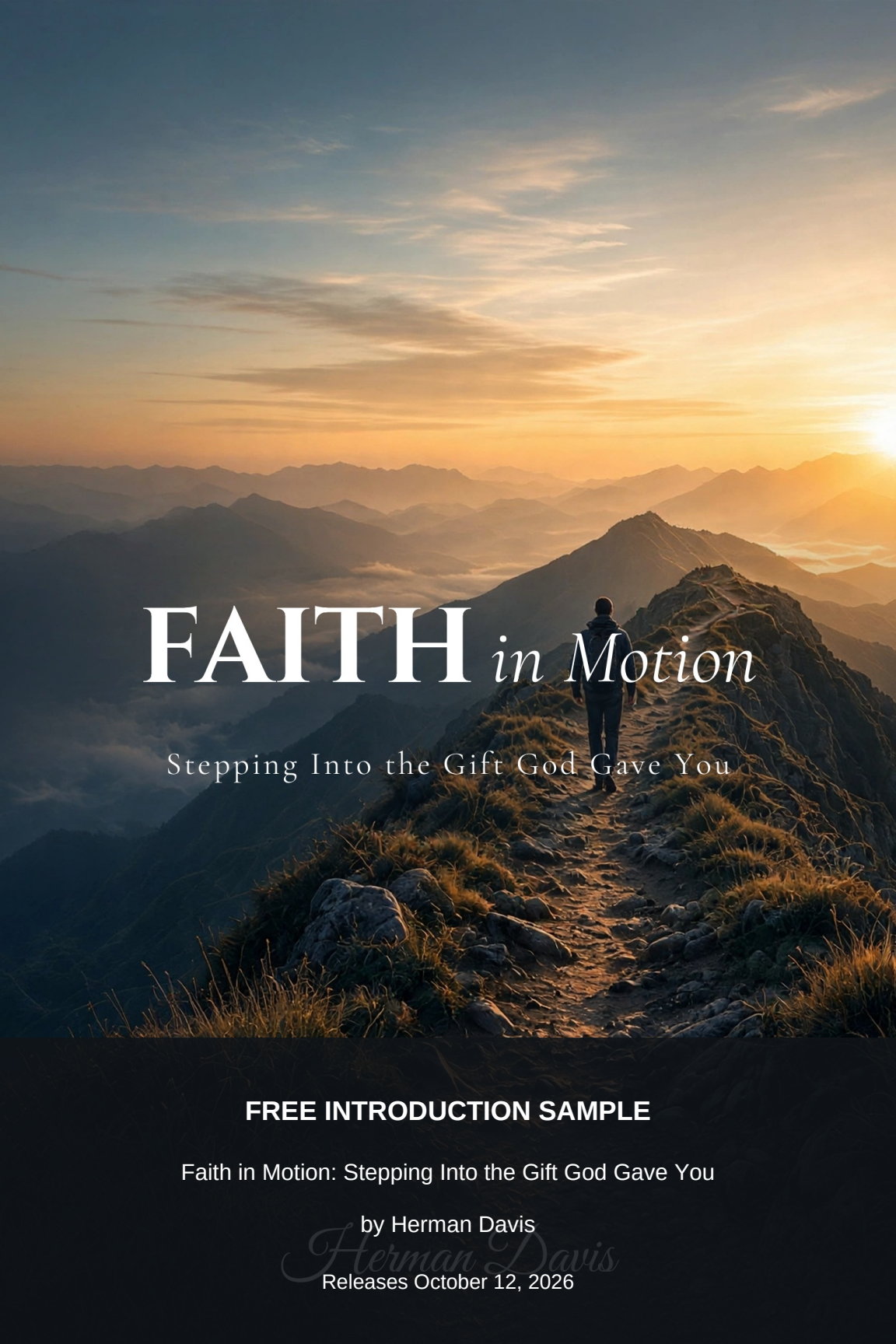


A person is seen from behind, walking along a rocky mountain trail. The sun is rising in the distance, casting a warm, golden glow over the landscape. The sky is filled with soft, wispy clouds. The mountains in the background are layered, creating a sense of depth. The overall mood is peaceful and inspiring.

FAITH *in Motion*

Stepping Into the Gift God Gave You

FREE INTRODUCTION SAMPLE

Faith in Motion: Stepping Into the Gift God Gave You

by Herman Davis

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INTRODUCTION

The Great Christian Standstill

Something has gone wrong in the way many of us talk about faith.

When conflict comes—when the numbers don’t add up, when the relationship frays, when the opportunity looks risky, when the next step is unclear—we freeze. Our hands stop. Our calendars stay empty of obedience. Our gifts sit unused. And then, almost without noticing, we baptize that freeze with holy language.

“I’m just trusting God.”

“I’m waiting on the Lord.”

“If God wants it to happen, He’ll open the door.”

Sometimes those sentences are true. Scripture is full of waiting that honors God. Abraham waited. David waited. The disciples waited in Jerusalem for the Spirit (Acts 1:4). There is a holy stillness that refuses to force what God has not authorized.

But there is also a counterfeit stillness—one that looks spiritual and feels safe—while it quietly refuses the very obedience God has already commanded. It uses the vocabulary of trust to cover the reality of fear. It calls paralysis “faith.” And because the words sound right, we rarely challenge it.

I have always believed in God. Trust was never a foreign word to me. I would have told you I trusted Him with my whole life.

What I misunderstood was what trust looked like.

I was taught to trust God like a chair: you don’t sit down wondering if it will break. You sit. You rest. That picture is not all wrong. Real faith does rest its weight on God. But my version of the picture stopped at sitting. In my mind, trust meant stillness. If I acted, I might be striving. If I waited, I was spiritual. So I waited. I called it faith. And under the pressure of providing for a house full of kids on one income, that “trust” became a freeze. Bills stacked. Losses came. Gifts God had already given me—a voice, influence, a mind that solves problems—sat unused while I waited for God to move the pieces I was supposed to steward.

I am not writing as a theology expert. I am writing as someone who learned, the hard way, what happens when you refuse to move and call it waiting on God. When I finally understood that trust is often confidence to act—not caution to stand still—my life changed.

If you know that freeze, this book is for you.

This book is about that line.

It is about the tension every serious Christian eventually feels: How do I trust God completely and still live a life of purpose—taking real steps, multiplying real gifts, walking through real doors He has placed in front of me?

Traditional Christian theology does not force you to choose between God’s sovereignty and your responsibility. Scripture holds both. God works. You work. God gives. You steward. God saves by grace. You walk in the good works He prepared beforehand. Faith rests—and faith moves.

James puts it without softness: “Faith by itself, if it does not have works, is dead” (James 2:17). He is not inventing a second gospel of earning favor with God. He is exposing a faith that never leaves the pew of the imagination—a faith that agrees in theory and stalls in practice.

Hebrews describes faith as confidence and assurance (Hebrews 11:1)—and then fills a whole chapter with people who did something because they believed.

Noah built. Abraham went. Moses left Egypt. The walls of Jericho fell after the people marched. Faith was never pictured as a Christian staring at the ceiling, renaming anxiety as piety.

Jesus told a story about a master who entrusted talents to his servants and expected increase (Matthew 25:14–30). The servant who buried what he was given did not celebrate safety. He heard a hard word: wicked and slothful. Preservation without multiplication was not faithfulness. It was fear dressed as

caution.

Paul guards the gospel with equal clarity. We are saved by grace through faith—not of ourselves, not of works—so that no one may boast (Ephesians 2:8–9). And in the next breath he says we are created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared beforehand, that we should walk in them (Ephesians 2:10). Grace does not cancel purpose. Grace launches it.

Elsewhere Paul writes: “Work out your own salvation with fear and trembling, for it is God who works in you, both to will and to work for his good pleasure” (Philippians 2:12–13). The Christian life is not God replacing you. It is God energizing you. Your effort does not compete with His power. It cooperates with it.

So why do we freeze?

Because uncertainty hurts. Because failure might be public. Because obedience might cost comfort, money, reputation, or control. Because in a noisy age it is easier to consume inspiration than to practice faithfulness. And because “trusting God” can become a religious permission slip to avoid the hard next step sitting in front of us.

This book will not scold you into frantic busyness. Busyness is not the same as purpose. Hustle is not holiness. We are not trying to replace prayer with panic or replace waiting with self-salvation.

We are trying to recover a biblical both/and:

Trust God as if everything depends on Him.

Act as a steward of what He has already placed in your hand.

God is not asking you to manufacture a destiny out of thin air. He is asking you to refuse the buried talent. He is inviting you to see opportunities and gifts as trusts—things He expects to be multiplied for His glory and for the good of others.

Here is the path ahead.

In Part 1 we reclaim what faith actually is: not a standstill, not a rival to grace, not a license to bury gifts, but a confidence that obeys when God says, “You do it.”

In Part 2 we look at the engine of purposeful action: a clear enough “why,” the Holy Spirit’s power, and wisdom that plans without pretending planning is unbelief.

In Part 3 we face the barriers: fear wearing faith’s clothes, foggy uncertainty, and the daily call to steward what is already in your hand—including the spheres of influence you may have treated as optional.

If you have been stuck—sincerely stuck—this book is for you. If you have loved God and still felt the shame of unused gifts, this book is for you. If you have prayed for open doors while ignoring the open door already in front of you, this book is for you.

You do not have to choose between trusting God and living on purpose.

Biblical faith does both.

Let's begin.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

1. Where have you baptized the freeze with holy language—"I'm just trusting God," "I'm waiting," or "He'll open the door"—when a clear duty was already in front of you?
2. In one honest sentence, what is your Great Christian Standstill right now?
3. Which half of the both/and do you most need: rest in God's sovereignty, or motion in stewardship?

PRACTICE THIS WEEK

Name your standstill in one sentence. Tell one trusted believer. Ask them to pray with you—and to ask you next week whether you took one clear next step. Bring one answer to a trusted believer this week.

CONTINUE THE JOURNEY

Continue the Journey

This is just the beginning. I wrote Faith in Motion for everyday believers who love God and still feel stuck, and I'd love for you to walk the rest of the journey with me.

The full book releases October 12, 2026 on Amazon: paperback \$14.99, Kindle \$4.99. Kindle pre-order:

<https://www.amazon.com/dp/B0HKV9P1FQ>.

Walk with me to launch day at faithinmotionbook.com, and name it. Step into it.

- Herman Davis